

Attendance Policy

NovaTech Innovations Inc.

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1. General Attendance Expectations

Commitment to Reliability

Punctuality and reliable attendance are fundamental expectations of all NovaTech Innovations employees. Consistent attendance ensures that teams can function efficiently, client deadlines are met, and an equitable workload is maintained across the organization.

This policy defines the standards for attendance, the procedures for reporting absences, and the consequences for excessive absenteeism or tardiness.

2. Work Hours and Scheduling

Standard Business Hours

NovaTech's standard business hours are Monday through Friday, 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM, including a one-hour unpaid lunch break. Shift workers or client-support teams may have differing schedules as determined by their department heads.

Employees are expected to be at their workstations (or logged in, if remote) and ready to begin work precisely at the start of their scheduled shift.

Flexible Scheduling

Where operational needs allow, managers may approve flexible start and end times (e.g., 8:00 AM to 5:00 PM). However, once a schedule is established, the employee must adhere to it consistently.

3. Reporting Absences and Tardiness

Notification Procedures

Unforeseen absences or delays happen. When an employee knows they will be late or absent, they must notify their direct manager via phone call or direct message at least one hour before their scheduled start time.

Sending an email to a general inbox or relying on a coworker to pass on the message is not considered proper notification. The employee must make direct contact with their supervisor.

No Call, No Show

A 'No Call, No Show' occurs when an employee is absent from work without notifying their supervisor. This is considered a severe breach of professional conduct.

A single instance of a No Call, No Show will result in a final written warning. Three consecutive days of No Call, No Show will be considered job abandonment and result in immediate voluntary termination of employment.

4. Types of Attendance Infractions

Tardiness

An employee is considered tardy if they log in or arrive more than 10 minutes past their scheduled start time without prior approval. Arriving late from lunch or breaks is also considered tardiness.

Occasional tardiness due to severe weather or transit emergencies is understandable, but chronic tardiness (e.g., more than three times in a month) will trigger disciplinary action.

Unscheduled Absences

An unscheduled absence is a failure to report to work without prior approval, utilizing sick leave, or experiencing a verifiable emergency.

While the company provides leave balances, utilizing them without proper notice disrupts business operations. Excessive unscheduled absences, even if the employee has leave balance remaining, will be managed as a performance issue.

5. Monitoring and Record Keeping

Time Tracking Systems

Hourly (non-exempt) employees are required to accurately clock in and out using the company's designated time and attendance software. Falsifying time records, or 'buddy punching' (clocking in for a colleague), is grounds for immediate dismissal.

Salaried (exempt) employees do not clock in and out but must accurately record their exception time (vacation, sick days) in the HRIS portal.

Important: Managers are required to review and approve timecards weekly, addressing any attendance anomalies immediately with the employee.

6. Roles and Responsibilities

Employee Responsibilities

Every employee at NovaTech Innovations is expected to familiarize themselves thoroughly with the Attendance Policy. Ignorance of the policy is not an acceptable excuse for non-compliance. Employees must actively apply these guidelines in their daily routines and decision-making processes.

It is the duty of the employee to seek clarification from their direct manager or the Human Resources department if any aspect of this policy is unclear. Furthermore, employees are required to report any known or suspected violations of this policy immediately through the appropriate channels.

- Read and acknowledge receipt of the policy document annually.
- Participate in mandatory compliance training sessions.
- Maintain transparency and open communication with management.
- Cooperate fully during any internal investigations related to policy breaches.

Managerial Responsibilities

Managers and supervisors act as the primary enforcers and role models for the Attendance Policy. They must ensure that their team members understand and adhere to all stipulations contained herein.

Managers are also responsible for consistently applying this policy without bias or favoritism. Any discrepancies in enforcement can lead to legal liabilities and a breakdown in team morale.

- Provide guidance and support to team members regarding policy details.

- Monitor compliance within their respective departments.
- Document and address any minor infractions through coaching and verbal warnings.
- Escalate severe or repeated violations to Human Resources.

Human Resources Responsibilities

The Human Resources (HR) department is the ultimate owner of the Attendance Policy. HR is tasked with ensuring the policy remains compliant with local, state, and federal laws, updating it as necessary to reflect organizational changes or legal requirements.

HR serves as an impartial mediator and investigator in cases where policy violations are reported. They are responsible for administering disciplinary actions in a fair and documented manner.

7. Policy Enforcement and Disciplinary Action

Progressive Discipline Framework

NovaTech Innovations employs a progressive discipline model to address violations of company policies. The goal of this framework is to correct undesired behavior and provide employees with the opportunity to improve, rather than immediately resorting to punitive measures.

However, the company reserves the right to bypass progressive steps and proceed directly to severe disciplinary action, including termination, for egregious offenses.

- Step 1: Verbal Warning - A documented conversation outlining the infraction and expected corrections.
- Step 2: Written Warning - A formal document placed in the employee's personnel file, detailing the failure to improve.
- Step 3: Final Written Warning / Suspension - Severe warning that may include unpaid suspension pending investigation.
- Step 4: Termination of Employment - Final action taken when previous steps fail or the offense is critically severe.

Investigation Procedures

Upon receiving a report of a policy violation, HR will initiate a prompt, thorough, and objective investigation. All parties involved, including witnesses, will be interviewed, and relevant documentation will be reviewed.

Confidentiality will be maintained to the highest degree possible throughout the investigation process to protect the privacy of the complainant, the accused, and any witnesses.

8. Review, Revisions, and Acknowledgement

Annual Review Cycle

The Attendance Policy is subject to an annual review by the executive committee and legal counsel. This ensures that the policy aligns with the evolving strategic goals of NovaTech Innovations and complies with all relevant employment laws.

Employees will be notified of any substantive changes to the policy via official company communication channels. Updated versions will be immediately available on the company intranet.

Employee Acknowledgement

Upon joining the company, and subsequently upon any major revision of this policy, employees will be required to sign a digital acknowledgement form. This form certifies that they have read, understood, and agreed to comply with the terms set forth.

Failure to sign the acknowledgement form does not exempt an employee from the requirement to adhere to the policy.